

Roman Key Card Blackwood - 1430 version

RKCB is similar to Blackwood, but instead of four Aces there are Five Keycards. They are the Aces plus the King of the agreed trump suit. Starting with 4NT, a reply of 5♣ shows 1 or 4 Keycards, 5♦ shows 0 or 3, 5♥ shows 2 Keycards but no trump Queen, and 5♠ shows 2 Keycards with the trump Queen.

If your side has all five Keycards, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings, remembering that there are only three Kings since the trump King is counted as a Keycard. There are two popular methods for responding to 5NT. The first is the same as normal Blackwood - 6♣ shows no Kings, 6♦ shows one, and 6♥ shows three. This is the method used in the recommended bidding here.

If the response to 4NT is 5♣ or 5♦ the 4NT bidder may choose to ask about the trump Queen rather than ask for Kings. She does this by bidding the cheapest non-trump suit. Partner denies the trump Queen by returning to the trump suit. A 5NT bid confirms the trump Queen, but shows no outside Kings. Bidding any non-trump suit confirms the trump Queen and also the King of the suit bid.

Void showing by Responder is handled just as in regular Blackwood except it refers to one or two Keycards, rather than one or two Aces.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣K

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♦J

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 5♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♦2

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♦Q

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 4 3
 ♥ 10 4
 ♦ A 6
 ♣ Q J 9 5 3

♠ K 5

♥ A K 9 7 6 2

♦ K 8

♣ 7 6 4



♠ Q 8 6

♥ 8

♦ 10 9 4 2

♣ A K 10 8 2

♠ A 9 7 2

♥ Q J 5 3

♦ Q J 7 5 3

♣ —

When SOUTH makes a Splinter bid, showing ♥ support and ♣ shortness, NORTH naturally thinks about slam.

She uses RKCB 4NT, and SOUTH, with one Key Card and a ♣ Void, bids 6♣.

Just what NORTH needed for the 6♥ bid.

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	6♣
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by North			
Lead: ♣K			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 6 3
♥ K Q 10 4
♦ K Q 8 5
♣ 2

♠ J 10 5

♥ 7 6 3

♦ 3 2

♣ 10 9 8 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 8 2

♥ A 9 5

♦ A 6 4

♣ K Q J

♠ 7 4

♥ J 8 2

♦ J 10 9 7

♣ A 7 5 4

WEST thinks they should be in slam, and uses Stayman to check for a 4-4 Major fit.

When EAST announces four ♠s WEST uses RKCB 4NT.

EAST's 5♠ bid shows two Key Cards plus the ♠Q.

This fills the holes in WEST's hand nicely, so she bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♠	Pass
6♠			
All Pass			
6♠ by East			
Lead: ♦ J			

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7 5

♥ J 2

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A 10 9 7 3

♠ A K 6 3

♥ K Q 10 4

♦ K Q 8 5

♣ 2



♠ Q 4

♥ 8 7 6 3

♦ 10 7 3

♣ 8 6 5 4

♠ J 9 8 2

♥ A 9 5

♦ A J 4

♣ K Q J

This is the companion hand to Deal 18.

Again, NORTH uses RKCB after the 4-4 ♠ fit is discovered. This time SOUTH shows two Key Cards without the ♠ Q.

Now NORTH realizes that in addition to one outside Ace, there is a very possible loser in trumps. So she stops at 5♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			
5♠ by South			
Lead: ♦ 2			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 4
♥ J 9 5
♦ A K 7 6
♣ A 5 4

♠ J 9 6 5

♥ 10 7

♦ Q J 9 8

♣ K 10 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7 3 2

♥ A K Q 8 6 4

♦ 5 3

♣ 8 7

♠ Q 10 8

♥ 3 2

♦ 10 4 2

♣ Q J 9 6 2

The chances of a slam on this hand are very small, and if WEST decides to use RKCB it will just confuse matters when EAST shows two Key Cards.

WEST has a better way to find out about the hand. She bids 2NT asking EAST to further describe his hand. EAST should then bid 3NT, showing a solid suit headed by AKQ.

EAST cannot have as much as an extra Jack, so WEST just passes 3NT.

West	North	East	South
		2♥	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♦ Q			